SS-B-656b
February 18, 1966

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. SS-B-00656a (GSA-FSS)
September 10, 1963, and
Fed. Spec. SS-B-656
June 28, 1932
(See 6.3)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BRICK, BUILDING, COMMON (CLAY OR SHALE)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers common building brick (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Grades.* The brick shall be of the following grades, as specified (see 6.2).

SW—Severe weathering.
MW—Moderate weathering.
NW—Negligible weathering.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640—Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-L-10547—Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap, Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147—Palletized Unit Loads (40″ X 48″ 4-Way Partial and 4-Way Pallets).

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(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply:

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Publications:

C 62—Specification for Building Brick (Solid Masonry Units Made from Clay or Shale).

C 67—Standard Methods of Sampling and Testing Brick.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19103.)

Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Grade. Each grade of brick shall meet the requirements of ASTM C 62.

3.2 Size. The size of brick shall be as specified (see 6.2).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any other commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling. The lot size and sample bricks required for visual examination, dimensional characteristics, and test shall be in accordance with ASTM C 67.

4.3 Test. Brick shall be tested in accordance with ASTM C 67.

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. The packing and marking of the brick shall be inspected to determine conformance with the applicable requirements of section 5. The packing and marking requirements of section 5 identified to referenced specifications and standards shall be inspected in accordance with applicable referenced specifications and standards. The packing requirements of section 5 not identified to referenced specifications shall be examined for defects listed in table I in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using an AQL of 4.0 percent defective.

TABLE I. *Classification of defects*

Examine	Defect	Major
Packing	Cushioning not provided when required	X
	Fiberboard boxes not waterproof sealed with tape as specified	X
	Case liners not provided ...	X
	Wood boxes not modified by the addition of skids as specified	X
	Closure and strapping not as specified	X
	Strapping not zinc coated when applicable	X
	Pallets not provided when specified	X

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement, the definitions and application of levels of packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.)

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified.

5.1.1 *Level A.*

5.1.1.1 *Grade SW brick.* Grade SW brick shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147 for type VII load.

5.1.1.2 *Grades MW and NW brick.* Grades MW and NW brick shall be packed in fiber-

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board, triple wall fiberboard, nailed and lock-corner wood or cleated plywood boxes conforming to PPP-B-636 (class weather-resistant); PPP-B-640 (class 2, grade A); PPP-B-621 (class 2); and PPP-B-601 (overseas type), respectively. Cushioning shall be used to fill all voids in order to insure a compact fit. Fiberboard boxes shall be waterproof sealed in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification. Wood boxes shall be lined with sealed case liners conforming to MIL-L-10547 and the appendix thereto. Wood boxes exceeding 250 pounds gross weight shall be modified by the addition of not less than two nominal 2- by 4-inch wood skids. The skids shall then be attached by nails, which shall be driven from the inside of the box while the skids are positioned flat across the bottom of the box, flush with the outside edges. Ends of the skids shall be beveled full depth at a 45° angle. Boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable box specification except that flat steel strapping shall be type I, class B.

5.1.2 *Level B.* The brick shall be packed as specified for level A except that boxes shall be domestic type or class, as applicable, waterproof sealing and case liner requirements do not apply and flat steel strapping requirements need not apply.

5.1.3 *Level C.* Level C packing of the subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate to the point of delivery.

5.1.4 *Palletization.* When specified (see 6.2), the packed brick shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147 for type I load.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 *Military activities.* In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Bricks covered by this specification are not intended for appearance purpose. They are classified on the basis of performance characteristics, dimensional tolerance, and strength; if a certain appearance standard is desired, the units should be obtained under the application classification specified in SS-B-668, Brick, Facing (Clay or Shale).

6.1.1 *Grade SW.* Brick intended for use where a high degree of resistance to frost action is desired and the exposure is such that water permeating the brick may be frozen.

6.1.2 *Grade MW.* Brick intended for use where exposed to temperatures below freezing but unlikely to be permeated with water, or where a moderate and somewhat nonuniform degree of resistance to frost action is permissible.

6.1.3 *Grade NW.* Brick intended for use as back-up or interior masonry or where no frost action occurs; or if frost action occurs, where the average precipitation is less than 20 inches.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Grade of brick desired (1.2.1).
(*c*) Size of brick desired (3.2).
(*d*) Level of packing required (5.1).
(*e*) If palletizing is required (5.1.4).
(*f*) Marking required (5.2).

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6.3 Supersession data for grades:

This specification	SS-B-656
Grade SW	Hard
Grade MW	Medium
Grade NW	Soft

6.4 Transportation descriptions. The transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Brick, building, common, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 60,000 pounds.

Motor:

Brick, building, common, not otherwise indexed.
Truckload minimum weight 60,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—MO-ERDL
Navy—YD
Air Force—69

Review activities:

Army—MO
Navy—YD
Air Force—69

User interest:

Army—MO, MU
Navy—CG

Military coordinating activity

Army—MO

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